

c. 1916, October

FATHER SOLANUS, NOTEBOOK No.2

Pg. 35

19th Sun. P.Pent. 1916

"Many Are Called but few are chosen." (Matt. XXII)
This holy gospel just read to you is a lesson of instruction indeed for every one of us. St. Gregory the Great tells us that the actions of Jesus even as His words are so many commands for those who wish to be His disciples. And here we see Him not only forgiving His enemies, not only condescending to speak to them, but by His earnest admonitions of them even though they are plotting to kill Him, He proves His words indeed, "I am come not to destroy but to save sinners." More than this, however, He brings forth a parable that every one can understand, a parable from which not only one but several dogmatic truths shine forth; a parable that must strike the pharisees as at once a condemnation of their attitude of pride, etc. and an invitation to better dispositions; a parable in fine that each and every one of us should take to heart, for the conclusion that Jesus Himself draws for us is this, "Many are called but few are chosen."

What He emphasizes especially in this parable, is the fact - the dogmatic truth, I. God wills all men to be saved and II. the same Almighty God will save no one without cooperation. "The kingdom of heaven is likened to a king who made a marriage for his son. And he sent His servants to call them ..." It is well to remember here the custom that still obtains in Eastern countries, that with every royal invitation to a wedding, there is always a nuptial garment for the guest invited. Hence, the insult to the king by the guest without the wedding garment. Now dear Br. we are all invited to the wedding that Almighty God has prepared. We have our nuptial garment received from God's own hand in baptism - the nuptial garment of sanctifying grace. If by mortal sin we have lost it, we must hasten by penance to get it back - indeed, God's messengers are continually urging us onward not only to preserve our wedding-garment and come to the marriage but to increase the original beauty of the same by growing more and more in sanctifying grace - receiving the sacraments frequently, uniting ourselves with Jesus in daily Communion, etc.,